

MCP Image System

The system should allow manually uploaded product images to become the official visual source for each **Master Canonical Product**.

Dispensary menu images are often inconsistent, missing, incorrect, low-resolution, duplicated, outdated, or replaced with generic stock images. Because of this, the MCP should control the final public-facing product image.

The system should store scraped dispensary images, but they should not automatically become the trusted product card image unless approved.

Image Source Rule

Each MCP should have one official image source.

Priority order:

1. Manually uploaded MCP image
2. Approved brand/product image
3. Approved scraped dispensary image
4. Category placeholder image
5. Generic fallback image

The public website should always display the highest-priority available image.

Official MCP Image

The official MCP image is the image uploaded directly into the product database.

This image becomes the consistent product card image used across:

- Product search
- Price comparison pages
- Product detail pages
- Brand pages
- Category pages

- Deal pages
- Reviews
- SEO pages
- Future signage templates

Example:

Stiiizy 1g Watermelon Z Liquid Diamonds Vape Pod

Even if five dispensaries show five different images, the MCP should display the one official uploaded image.

Category Placeholder Images

If no official MCP image exists yet, the system should display a category placeholder image.

Each major category should have its own placeholder.

Examples:

Vape Placeholder

Flower Placeholder

Pre-Roll Placeholder

Edible Placeholder

Beverage Placeholder

Concentrate Placeholder

Tincture Placeholder

Topical Placeholder

Accessory Placeholder

This keeps the site visually clean while the product database is still being filled in.

Example:

If a vape product has no uploaded image yet, show the default **Vape Placeholder** image.

If a gummy product has no uploaded image yet, show the default **Edible Placeholder** image.

No broken images. No ugly blank cards. No mystery gray sadness rectangles.

Scraped Store Images

Each Dispensary Product Listing can still store the image pulled from the dispensary menu.

However, scraped store images should be treated as unverified.

A scraped image may be:

- Correct
- Incorrect
- A stock image
- A brand logo
- A category image
- A duplicated image from another product
- A low-resolution menu thumbnail
- Missing entirely

Because of this, store images should live on the DPL as source data, not as the MCP truth image.

MCP Image Fields

The MCP should include image-related fields:

canonical_image_id
canonical_image_url
image_status
image_source
image_alt_text
placeholder_category
uses_placeholder
image_updated_at

Recommended `image_status` values:

missing
placeholder
uploaded
approved_scraped
brand_supplied
needs_review

Recommended `image_source` values:

manual_upload
brand_asset
scraped_menu
category_placeholder
generic_placeholder

DPL Image Fields

Each Dispensary Product Listing should keep its own scraped image data.

image_url_from_store
image_source_platform
image_hash
image_width
image_height
image_status
image_review_status

This lets the system compare images later, flag bad ones, or promote a scraped image into the MCP if manually approved.

Recommended Media Tables

media_assets

Stores every uploaded or scraped image.

id
asset_url
asset_type
source_type
source_platform
source_store_id
uploaded_by

file_name
mime_type
width
height
image_hash
created_at
updated_at

master_product_images

Connects images to MCPs.

id
master_product_id
media_asset_id
image_role
is_primary
approval_status
source_type
created_at
updated_at

Recommended **image_role** values:

primary
alternate
package_front
package_back
lifestyle
placeholder

Recommended **approval_status** values:

approved
pending_review
rejected
auto_placeholder

category_placeholders

Stores the fallback image for each category and form.

id
category
form
placeholder_image_url
active
created_at
updated_at

Examples:

Category: Vape
Form: Vape Pod
Placeholder: vape-pod-placeholder.png

Category: Vape
Form: Disposable
Placeholder: disposable-placeholder.png

Category: Edible
Form: Gummy
Placeholder: gummy-placeholder.png

Category: Beverage
Form: Beverage
Placeholder: beverage-placeholder.png

Image Selection Logic

When rendering a product card, the system should choose the image like this:

If MCP has approved uploaded image:
 show uploaded MCP image

Else if MCP has approved brand/product image:
 show approved brand/product image

Else if MCP has approved scraped image:
show approved scraped image

Else if category/form placeholder exists:
show category/form placeholder

Else:
show generic product placeholder

Admin Image Workflow

The admin should allow images to be managed directly from the MCP product page.

Admin actions:

- Upload official product image
- Replace official product image
- View scraped images from connected dispensary listings
- Approve scraped image as MCP image
- Reject incorrect scraped image
- Assign category placeholder
- Edit image alt text
- Mark image as needs review

This gives control without throwing away useful scraped image evidence.

Final Rule

The MCP owns the official product image.

The DPL stores whatever image the dispensary menu provides.

If the MCP does not have an official image yet, the site displays a clean category placeholder until a proper image is uploaded.

This keeps the product universe visually consistent, even when dispensary menus are messy, wrong, incomplete, or using stock images.

